

Activity 7: Candidate-Side Practice: Web App, Prep Coach and the STAR Upgrade

Duration: 40 minutes **Roles:** Candidate and peer coach, then interviewer/candidate/observer for the role play

Scenario

You switch sides. First you practise as a candidate in two different tools, then you run the live interviewer role play.

Goal and output

A practice transcript, a before-and-after STAR answer, a tool comparison and a role-play transcript.

Tools and data boundary

AI Interview Practice Lab (web app, Demo mode) | Interview Prep Coach (KEEP) agent | your approved interview pack

Use only supplied de-identified training data. Do not enter live candidate data, employer-confidential information or production API keys.

Detailed step-by-step

Step 1

PART A - Open the AI Interview Practice Lab web app at <https://alfredang.github.io/AllInterviewing/> and choose a role and difficulty.

Step 2

Use Demo mode so no API key and no personal data are required. Complete at least six questions.

Step 3

Read the criterion-level feedback and identify your lowest-scoring criterion and the transcript evidence behind it.

Step 4

PART B - Give the same weak answer to the Interview Prep Coach agent and ask for a STAR rewrite.

Step 5

Compare the two tools: the web app scores against a fixed rubric; the Copilot agent coaches conversationally and can be grounded in policy. Note when each is the better choice.

Step 6

Rewrite your weakest answer with concise Situation/Task and detailed Action/Result, marking any gap as [candidate to supply] rather than inventing facts.

Step 7

PART C - Now swap to the interviewer seat. Assign roles and give only the candidate card to the candidate.

Step 8

Deliver the transparent opening, ask the approved core questions in sequence, and use only neutral probes while the observer marks leading language, evidence gaps and time drift.

Step 9

Close with candidate questions and next steps, then debrief from all three perspectives.

Evidence files

- star_upgrade.txt
- tool_comparison.txt
- candidate_card.txt
- observer_notes.csv

Recovery and troubleshooting

If the tool output is missing, generic, biased or ungrounded, preserve the input and output, mark the item as rejected, revise one constraint at a time, and regenerate. If access fails, use the supplied templates and local/demo mode; do not substitute live candidate data.

Completion criterion

A practice transcript, a before-and-after STAR answer, a tool comparison and a role-play transcript.